



The
Fitzwilliam
Museum
CAMBRIDGE

University of Cambridge Museums

Nursery in Residence

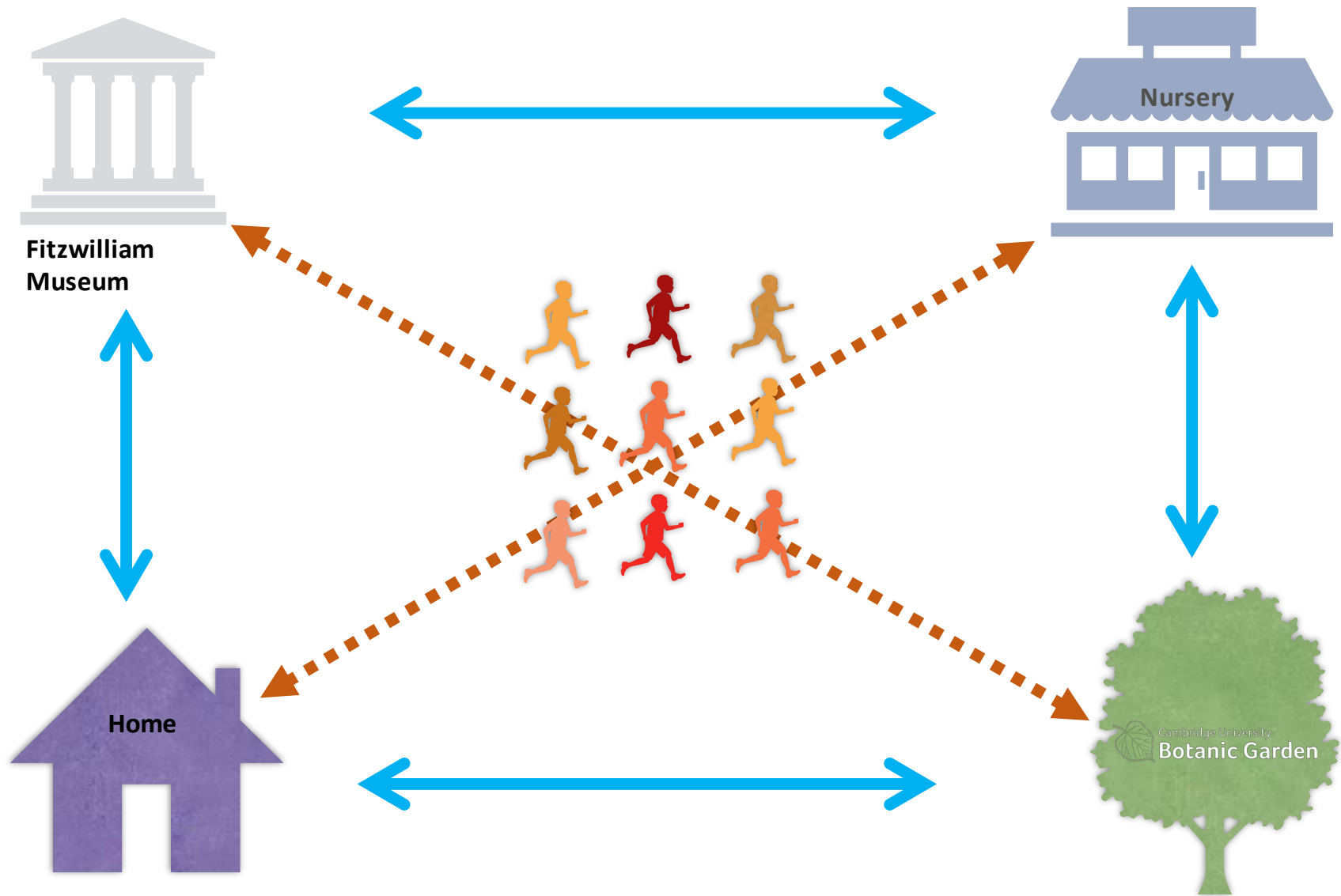
Felicity Plent & Bronwen Richards, CUBG

Nicola Wallis & Kate Noble, The Fitzwilliam
Museum

@CUBGEducation

@FitzMuseumEduca





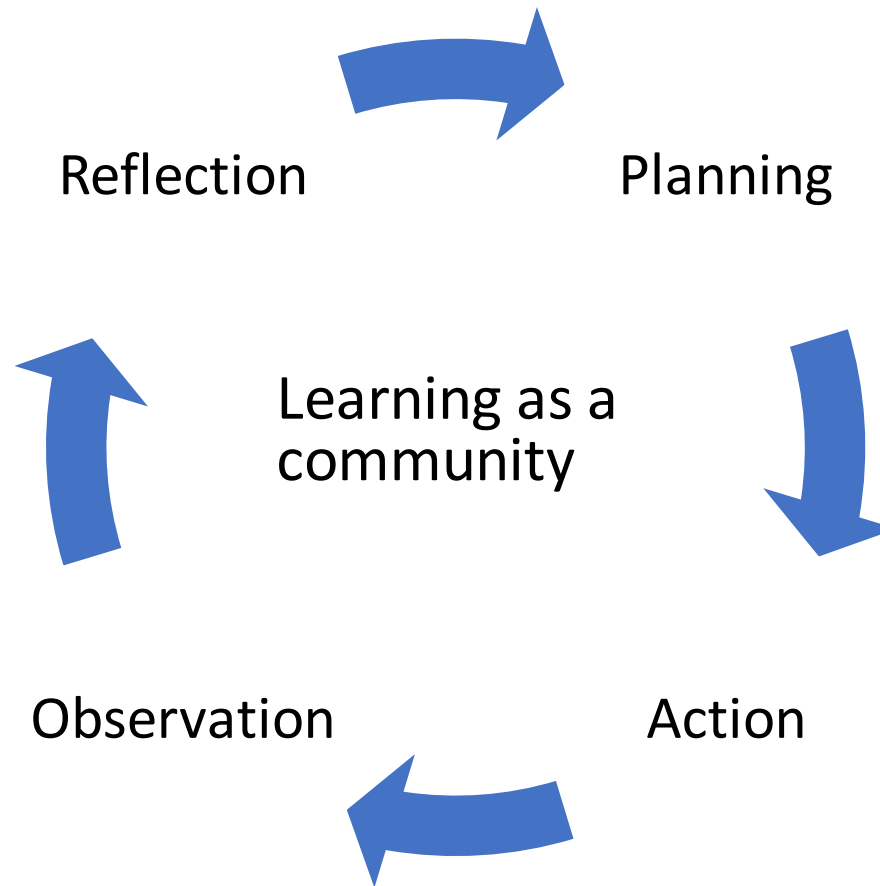


5 days
9 children
7 educators
15 practitioner surveys
25 pages of field notes
500 photos
And 1000s of leaves!



‘Stand aside for a while and leave room for learning, observe what children do, and then, if you have understood it well, perhaps teaching will be different from before.’

Loris Malaguzzi



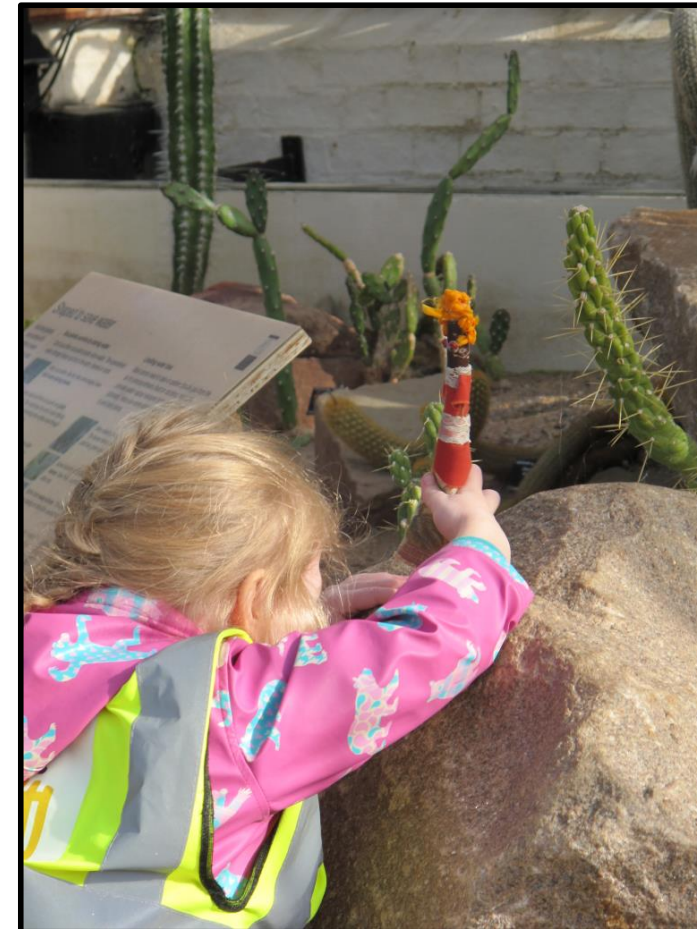
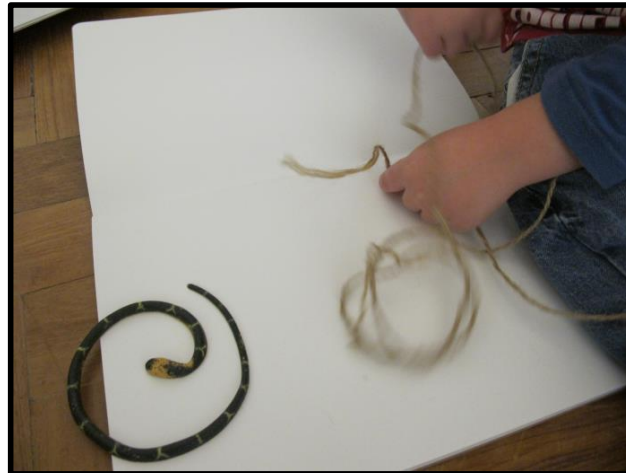
Young children care about our collections



We make meaning collaboratively and multimodally



Objects can help us to connect different experiences



Play here.....but not here



There is a tension
between freedom and
control in these spaces

You can lay on the floor...
..but you can't use that door



KEEP OFF...but look at this



A research focus gave us time to see things differently

[I was inspired] to really take the time with children and really listen to them. When they're a group of course you try to do it, but I tried even more when I came back.

I thought, these children had this gift that we gave them: all this attention. So I tried to do it even more when I came back.

Because that's what children need – to be listened to. And that's what you did. And we did, that week.

Post Project Interview
with Nursery Practitioner



Making space for children

'It was just so beautiful to think: this is our place; we know this place.'

That's what you want: for children to feel free. That they belong there.'

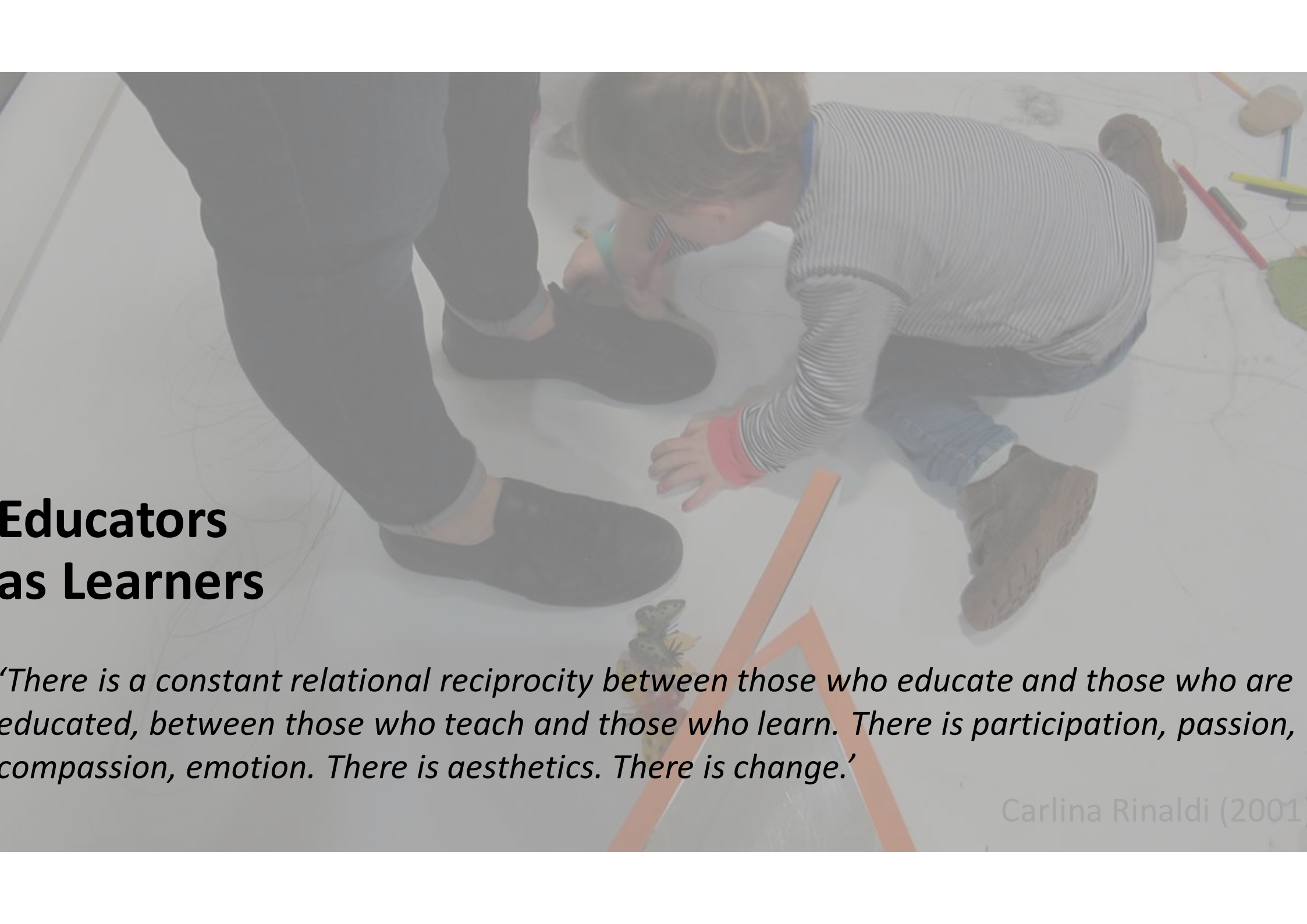
Post Project Interview
with Nursery Practitioner

Adult: *Whose garden is this then?*

Alanna: *Ours - children's.*

Transcription from video footage



A high-angle, top-down photograph of a child and an adult sitting on a white floor, engaged in a drawing activity. The child, wearing a grey and white striped long-sleeved shirt and blue jeans, is crouched and drawing with a pink marker. The adult, wearing dark trousers and black shoes, is also crouched, holding a green marker. Various drawing supplies like markers and a small wooden toy are scattered on the floor around them. The scene is brightly lit, and the floor is a plain, light color.

Educators as Learners

'There is a constant relational reciprocity between those who educate and those who are educated, between those who teach and those who learn. There is participation, passion, compassion, emotion. There is aesthetics. There is change.'

Carlina Rinaldi (2001)

Next steps: 'Lines of Enquiry'

'We could see how much those nine children got from it, so actually, let's branch it out, let's give this kind of experience to all the children.'

Post Project Interview with Nursery Practitioner

